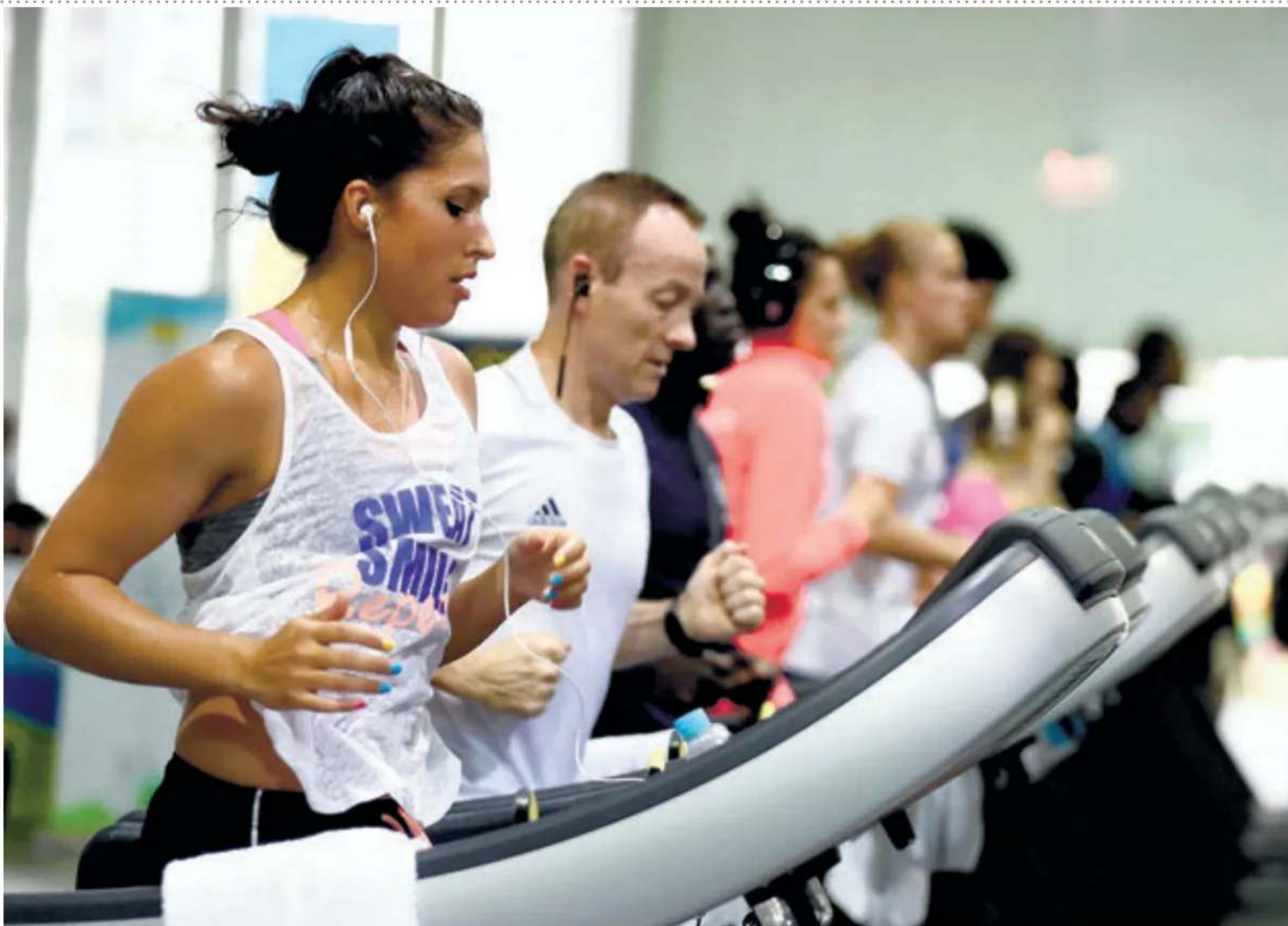




Making the most of it: By strategically alternating between fasting days with low-intensity training and pre-feed days with higher-intensity sessions, elite athletes can harness the potential benefits of fasted training. GETTY IMAGES

and training protocols, consuming carbohydrates in the hours leading up to a workout ensures adequate glycogen availability, optimising performance, and supporting muscle function during demanding activities.

Pre-workout meal options can include traditional dishes that provide a balance of carbohydrates, proteins, and fats to fuel performance and facilitate recovery. Some delicious and nutritious options include:

- * Paneer paratha: A whole wheat flatbread stuffed with paneer (Indian cottage cheese) and spices provide a hearty source of carbohydrates, protein, and healthy fats.

- * Upma: A savoury dish made from semolina (rava), vegetables, and spices. Upma offers a quick and energy-dense option for pre-workout fuel.

- * Banana almond smoothie: Blend ripe bananas with almond milk,

almonds, and a dash of honey for a refreshing and nutrient-rich beverage packed with carbohydrates, protein, and essential vitamins and minerals.

- * Moong dal khichdi: A comforting combination of rice and split green gram (moong dal), seasoned with spices and topped with ghee (clarified butter), provides a balanced source of carbohydrates and protein, along with essential fatty acids.

- * Sweet potato chaat: Roasted sweet potatoes tossed with spices, chickpeas, yoghurt, and fresh herbs offer a flavourful and nutrient-dense pre-workout snack, rich in complex carbohydrates, protein, and fibre.

By strategically alternating between fasting days with low-intensity training and pre-feed days with higher-intensity sessions, elite athletes can harness the potential benefits of fasted training while minimising the risk of

performance limitations. This balanced approach allows for metabolic adaptations without compromising training quality or recovery.

The decision to work out in a fasted state for elite athletes is complex and multifaceted. While there may be potential benefits in terms of metabolic adaptations and fat oxidation, it's crucial to consider individual factors, performance goals, and the specific demands of the sport. Consulting with a sports nutritionist or healthcare professional can provide personalised guidance and ensure that fasting strategies are implemented safely and effectively within an athlete's training regimen. My final advice, is do not fast without having all your body assessment details, blood chemistry, and training load data in place before you put your food on hold.